

Council Meeting
February 25, 2026
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The Claremont City Council held a meeting on Wednesday, February 25, 2026, in the Council Chambers of City Hall.

The meeting was called to order by Assistant Mayor Matteau at 6:30 p.m.

Members of the Council present:

Ward I Councilor Andrew O’Hearne
Ward II Councilor William Greenrose
Ward III Councilor Christopher Irish
Assistant Mayor Debora Matteau
At-Large Councilor Christopher Cogswell
At-Large Councilor Wayne Hemingway
At-Large Councilor William Limoges
At-Large Councilor Nicholas Koloski
Mayor Dale Girard – Absent

Also present:

Nancy Bates, City Manager

AGENDA CHANGES

None.

REPORT OF THE SECRETARY

A motion was made by Councilor Hemingway and seconded by Councilor Greenrose to accept the minutes of the February 11, 2026, City Council meeting.

Councilor O’Hearne asked to modify page 10 to add motions related to the CDA Discussion. Councilor Hemingway and Councilor Greenrose accepted

Voice vote:

**O’Hearne – yes
Cogswell – yes
Greenrose – yes
Matteau – yes
Koloski – yes
Limoges – yes
Hemingway – yes**

Irish - yes
Motion carried 8-0

MAYOR'S NOTES

Claremont youth softball and baseball registration is open until March 12th.

Parks and Recreation will be starting their work on the 2026 scholarship golf tournament, hosted on May 20th at 10:00am.

Twin State Valley Youth basketball tournament is ongoing until March 7th.

School Vote will be held on March 10th.

A Motion was made by Councilor O'Hearne and seconded by Councilor Cogswell to accept a resignation from Mr. Coburn of the Parks and Recreation Commission.

Councilor Koloski stated other resignations have recently come forward and those weren't accepted. Councilor Irish stated the Council does not have to accept.

Councilor O'Hearne noted the Council has done this before and that they are the appointing and removal authority for boards and commissions so when someone resigns, they should resign with the Council.

Councilor Koloski stated he would be voting no. Councilor Irish stated this shouldn't be done under Mayors Notes.

Assistant Mayor Matteau stated the Council may need to establish this as practice but is uncomfortable making this an issue for tonight.

A motion was made by Councilor Koloski and seconded by Councilor Irish to table the acceptance of Mr. Coburn's resignation.

Roll call:
O'Hearne – no
Cogswell – yes
Greenrose – yes
Matteau – yes
Koloski – yes
Limoges – yes
Hemingway – yes
Irish - yes
Motion carried 7-1

CITY MANAGER'S REPORT

City Manager Bates gave a shoutout to City staff, the Fire Department has had a busy couple of weeks and a few calls worth noting. Thursday February 12th, crews responded to a reported fire, and Off-Duty Call Firefighter Koloski arrived first on scene and assisted an occupant out prior to the arrival of the on-duty crews. February 13th crews responded to Pleasant Street for report of smoke- heavy smoke conditions were found in the basement traced to a furnace, there were high levels of carbon monoxide on all floors and the building was fully evacuated.

Later that evening crews were dispatched and Police arrived first on scene and assisted residents to safety while also sheltering pets in their cruisers.

Department of Public Works has been busy with addressing the weather and several water breaks due to cold temperatures.

Manager Bates noted being impressed by City personnel and proud to be a part of the team.

Welcoming George Smith as the City's new Project Manager.

Leigh Hayes, former health officer, will be working on a temporary part time basis one day a week until the Chief position is filled.

Personnel Advisory Board currently has one member and encourages citizens to apply.

Sugar river revitalization – working with Merchant McIntyre to develop timing to move forward with the Sugar River Revitalization project which the City just received funding for. The City Planner will be asking the Conservation Commission for an update on the connection of the two tracks of land that are involved. Steps will include finalizing project design followed by an RFP.

County delegation will be at the next council meeting to speak about several areas of concern related to traffic safety in Claremont.

The City staff is organizing a Celebrate Claremont event in conjunction with the fourth of July celebration for the nations 250th, events will be held Friday July 3rd afternoon preceding the fireworks and more events Saturday morning.

Councilor Irish gave a shout out to DPW for a quick response time with a citizen complaint about an icy sidewalk and a dripping roof on Pleasant Street.

CITIZEN'S FORUM

Assistant Mayor Matteau gave reminder that Citizen's forum is designed to allow you the opportunity to make the Council aware of your concerns. Please state your name and ward number, we ask you to address your concerns directly to the Council. The Council Manager will not be responding to you during this time. You are limited to five minutes on any non-agenda items. In the back of the room please write down your contact information if you'd like to be contacted as well as your concern on the clipboard for follow-up.

Norm Blouin, Ward III, thanked all who attended Saturday's school board meeting. Mr. Blouin then shared concerns for potholes, a walkway between downtown and the railway, budget, the Planning Department, businesses being empty, restaurants not being open on Monday and Tuesdays, and the school system, and stated there needs to be a new way of running this town.

OLD BUSINESS

Upper Valley Aquatic Center Follow-Up Discussion

Director Martin, reviewed cost accessibility being the top priority, and scholarship opportunities would be leveraged to bridge any financial gaps for families in need, UVAC has expressed interest in maintaining member and non-member pricing structures.

Protecting access to current lap swimmers is essential, there is no intention to displace existing users.

The potential to host swim meets, and bringing family and visitors to the community.

Parking will be managed as it is today offering overflow at the tech center and middle school, and if necessary the community center has access to the bus where potentially people can be shuttled from the college or garage.

The Recreation Department would be recommending a fee schedule adjustment.

Another benefit could be a homegrown pipeline for lifeguards.

Councilor Limoges stated this is a great idea and asked if something went wrong can the City back out.

Manager Bates noted this would be a pilot program for six months.

Councilor Koloski asked if there were enough cleaning supplies.

Director Martin replied yes and a backup vacuum.

Councilor Cogswell stated only seeing positives for future lifeguards.

FY27 Budget Hearing Schedule – Public Hearing

Changed two dates to Tuesday to not interfere with other board meetings.

By consensus Council agrees with the Budget Hearing Schedule.

Assistant Mayor Matteau opened a public hearing, no one spoke, Assistant Mayor Matteau closed the public hearing.

NEW BUSINESS

Resolution 2026-30 Transfer of funds for LinkedIn – Public Hearing

Manager Bates noted the LinkedIn subscription was presented with the Human Resources Director at A previous meeting and is now looking to transfer funds to cover expenses.

RESOLUTION 2026-30

2026 BUDGET LINE-ITEM TRANSFER OF FUNDS - LINKEDIN MEMBERSHIP SUBSCRIPTION

WHEREAS the City Council of the City of Claremont, New Hampshire (the “City Council”) has approved funding for a 1-year LinkedIn Membership subscription; and

WHEREAS the Human Resources Department utilizes LinkedIn as a recruitment tool to attract and engage qualified candidates for City employment opportunities; and

WHEREAS the annual subscription cost for LinkedIn of \$19,125.00 is unbudgeted for FY2026; and

BE IT RESOLVED by the City Council, after public hearing duly noticed, authorizes a transfer of \$19,125.00 from Regular Pay 001-412-412-101-0000 to Contractual Services 001-418-418520-0010 (with no impact on the tax rate); and

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED that the City Manager or Treasurer or their designees are hereby authorized to undertake all actions and execute all documents as may be required to implement this resolution. *(2/3 Vote Required)*

Dated this 25th day of February 2026 the City of Claremont, County of Sullivan, State of New Hampshire.

A motion was made by Councilor Hemingway and seconded by Councilor Limoges to accept Resolution 2026-30.

Councilor Hemingway read Resolution 2026-30 into the record.

Assistant Mayor Matteau opened the public hearing, no one spoke. Assistant Mayor Matteau closed the public hearing.

Roll call:

O’Hearne – yes

Cogswell – yes

Greenrose – yes

Matteau – yes

Koloski – yes

Limoges – yes

Hemingway – yes

Irish - yes

Motion carried 8-0

Resolution 2026-31 Water Sewer Rate Study Funding - Public Hearing

Manager Bates explained that the review committee is recommending moving forward with Raftelis this is coming out equally from water and sewer with no impact on water, sewer, or the tax rate.

Councilor O’Hearne questioned if this study was done before and why the City would be doing it again. Manager Bates explained the City is required to do a rate study every five years and the rates run out at the end of our current fiscal year.

RESOLUTION 2026-31

Water/Sewer Rate Study Funding

WHEREAS following a formal RFP process for a 5-Year Water/Sewer rate study, the Water/Sewer Rate Study Review Committee has recommended a vendor from those that submitted bids; and

WHEREAS the Water and Sewer Utility Divisions would like to move forward with the selected vendor;

BE IT RESOLVED by the City Council of Claremont NH, after public hearing duly noticed, that it hereby raises and appropriates \$44,730 in equal portions of \$22,365 from the Water Fund

Balance and \$22,365 from the Sewer Fund balance, held respectively in accounts 100100003 and 100100004 at NHPDIP (no impact on the tax rate), to engage the chosen vendor in a 5-Year water/sewer rate study; and

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED that the City Manager or Treasurer or their designees are hereby authorized to undertake all actions and execute all documents as may be required to implement this resolution. *(2/3 Vote Required)*

Dated this 25th day of February 2026 the City of Claremont, County of Sullivan, State of New Hampshire.

A motion was made by Councilor Limoges and seconded by Councilor Koloski to accept Resolution 2026-31.

Councilor Limoges read Resolution 2026-31 into the Record.

Assistant Mayor Matteau opened a public hearing, no one spoke. Assistant Mayor Matteau closed the public hearing.

Roll call:

O’Hearne – yes

Cogswell – yes

Greenrose – yes

Matteau – yes

Koloski – yes

Limoges – yes

Hemingway – yes

Irish - yes

Motion carried 8-0

AARP Grant Discussion for Pavilion at Monadnock Park

Director Martin explained an opportunity to apply for funding to construct a pavilion at Monadnock Park.

Councilor Irish thinks this is a great idea and noted it checks the boxes for CIP, Master Plan, and potentially no cost to taxpayers with the idea the left-over funding needed could be donated.

By consensus City Council agrees to move forward with the application.

Resolution 2026-32 Scoreboard Donation from Asetex Tire

Director Martin fully supports this donation and requests acceptance from the Council, while thanking all the partners that made this possible. Representatives from MAAC Tow LLC. And Astex Tire were in attendance.

RESOLUTION 2026-32

Asetex Tire and Auto/MAACS Tow LLC. Scoreboard Donation

BE IT RESOLVED by the City Council of the City of Claremont, New Hampshire, after a public hearing duly noticed, that

WHEREAS the Claremont Parks and Recreation Department, together with Claremont Youth Baseball and Softball Association and Asetex Tire and Auto/MAACS Tow LLC. would like to accept a Daktronics BA-618 Scoreboard and additional materials (console, receiver, and logo panel) valued at a total of \$9,535.00 in donation for use on Field #2 at Monadnock Park

WHEREAS, Claremont Parks and Recreation Department has recommended a new scoreboard to replace a non-working scoreboard as this would provide a better playing experience to all the constituents that utilize Field #2 at Monadnock Park

WHEREAS the City desires to approve the installation of the scoreboard for the benefit of its citizens by accepting funding from CYBSA in the amount of \$2,200.00 to cover all installation costs

NOW THEREFORE BE IT RESOLVED THAT the City Council hereby authorizes the Parks and Recreation Director or his designees to undertake the acceptance of this scoreboard and to approve the installation on Field #2 at Monadnock Park (with no impact on the tax rate); and

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED to accept the additional materials; RC-200 console, receiver kit, and logo panel

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED that the City Manager or her designees are hereby authorized to execute all documents and undertake all actions as may be required to implement this resolution.
(2/3 Vote Required)

Dated this 25th day of February, 2026, the City of Claremont, County of Sullivan, State of New Hampshire.

A motion was made by Councilor Cogswell and seconded by Councilor Irish to accept Resolution 2026-32.

Councilor Cogswell read Resolution 2026-32.

Assistant Mayor Matteau opened a public hearing, no one spoke. Assistant Mayor Matteau closed the public hearing.

Councilor Hemingway thanked all for their donation of the score board and work to get it installed.

Roll call:

O’Hearne – yes

Cogswell – yes

Greenrose – yes

Matteau – yes

Koloski – yes

Limoges – yes

Hemingway – yes

Irish - yes

Motion carried 8-0

Resolution 2026-33 Library donation from the Carnegie Corporation

Director Grace explained this was a donation from Carnegie of New York, and they are sending \$10,000 to all existing Carnegie libraries in the state and Claremont is one of them.

RESOLUTION 2026-33

Carnegie Corporation of New York Donation

BE IT RESOLVED by the Claremont City Council, after a public hearing duly noticed, that:

WHEREAS the City of Claremont, New Hampshire has been awarded a donation in the amount of \$10,000.00 from the **Carnegie Corporation of New York** in celebration of the 250th anniversary of the Declaration of Independence and in recognition of The Fiske Free Library being one of 1350-plus surviving Carnegie Libraries; and

WHEREAS this donation is given to the Fiske Free Library without conditions or expectations for the benefit of the library and the community; and

WHEREAS the City would like to accept and expend this donation from the **Carnegie Corporation of New York** for its intended purpose;

NOW THEREFORE BE IT RESOLVED that the City Council hereby authorizes the City Manager or her designees to undertake all actions and execute all documents as may be required

to accept a donation in the amount of \$10,000.00 from the **Carnegie Corporation of New York** for benefit of the Fiske Free Library; and

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED to raise and appropriate the sum of \$10,000.00 for the Fiske Free Library to come from the **Carnegie Corporation of New York Donation** (to have no impact on the tax rate); and

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED that the City Manager or her designees are hereby authorized to execute all documents and undertake all actions as may be required to implement this resolution. *(2/3 Vote Required)*

Dated this 25th day of February, 2026, the City of Claremont, County of Sullivan, State of New Hampshire.

A motion was made by Councilor Hemingway and seconded by Councilor Koloski to accept resolution 2026-33.

Councilor Hemingway read Resolution 2026-33 into the record.

Assistant Mayor Matteau opened a public hearing, no one spoke. Assistant Mayor Matteau closed the public hearing.

Roll call:

O'Hearne – yes

Cogswell – yes

Greenrose – yes

Matteau – yes

Koloski – yes

Limoges – yes

Hemingway – yes

Irish - yes

Motion carried 8-0

COMMITTEE REPORTS

Councilor O'Hearne reported the Tolles Home treasurer is working on a budget.

Councilor Cogswell reported the Conservation Commission had a presentation from Upper Valley Trails Alliance on the impacts of microplastics.

Councilor Greenrose reported that the Energy Advisory Board had a presentation from Free Energy Logistics; an alternate option to Sullivan County Community Power Program, the goal is to bring a recommendation to Council by late spring.

Assistant Mayor Matteau reported Planning gave a conditional use permit to add one ADU on Pleasant Street converting a former commercial space to a residential space.

Councilor Koloski noted the Arts Committee is still accepting eagle restoration donations and preparing for the next art exhibit at the visitor's center.

Councilor Irish added the Procurement Policy Meeting will be held March 5th at 1pm.

FUTURE AGENDA ITEMS AND DIRECTIVES

Councilor Limoges would like there to be a council seat on the Parks and Recreation Commission.

Assistant Mayor Matteau asked Manager Bates to research how councilors were appointed to the board previously and bring back the information.

CONSULTATION WITH LEGAL COUNSEL

None.

ADJOURNMENT

At 7:38 p.m., a motion was made by Councilor O'Hearne and seconded by Councilor Limoges to adjourn.

Voice vote:

O'Hearne – yes

Cogswell – yes

Greenrose – yes

Matteau – yes

Koloski – yes

Limoges – yes

Hemingway – yes

Irish - yes

Motion carried 8-0

Respectfully Submitted,

Julia A. Bizzarro
Clerk to the Council